

Old Business

for

Piano, Bass, Drum Set,
and Narrator

Based on poetry by

Charles Simic

(*from Dismantling the Silence,*
IV: *Bestiary for the Fingers of My Right Hand**)

*poem used by permission of the author

Music by Christopher Kies

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Bestiary for the Fingers of My Right Hand

1.

Text by Charles Simic
Music by Christopher Kies

$\text{♩} = 76$

Drum Set

Piano

Bass

p *mp* *f*

ped. ** ped.*

bass sounds octave lower than written

Narrator: "Thumb,....
At the time of my birth.

$\text{♩} = 96$

5 ride (scrape)

D.S.

mf Narr.: It takes four to hold him down, Bend him in half, Begins to whimper.

Pno.

mf *mp*

Cb.

pizz. *gliss.*

sul II *mf*

sn. toms sn. kick-bass

f

9 ride bell

D.S.

mf *f*

H.H. closed

(Narration lasts ca. 8 sec.s)

Narr.: Cut him off. He....
....hunting with wolves.

Pno.

mf

Cb.

mf

2.

"Tango" $\text{♩} = 66$

Drum Set

2 Bongos
2 Congas

mp *f* *mp*

T. (tone) B. (bass)

Piano

close keyboard cover,
and play "piano percussion"

Bass

pizz. *gliss.*

Narrator

N.B.: In this movement, the narrator may choose to imitate somewhat the style of speech-song that one would hear in a Kurt Weill opera.

left hand, knuckles on keyboard cover
right hand, flat 2nd finger, on keyboard cover

The se-cond

Piano Perc.

mf *m.d. 2* *m.s. sopra* *m.s. sotto* *m.s. knuckles* *mp*

flat of left hand, fingers 2-5, under key bed
flat of left hand, fingers 2-5, on keyboard cover

4

D.S.

T.

p

3

Cb.

4

Nar.

mp

points the way. True way. The path cros-ses the earth,

Pno. Perc.

p

3.

♩ = 80 "Third Finger Blues"

Drum Set

Piano

Bass

(solo to be played only with the third finger of the right hand)

mf

3

3

3

3

3

2

D.S.

Pno.

Cb.

mp

3

3

3

3

3

3

4

D.S.

Pno.

Cb.

mp

f

p

f

pizz.

mf

(drums vamp with bass for four bars)

3

3

3

3

3

3

4.

$\text{♩} = 54$ take medium soft/wrapped mallets

Drum Set

(piano part: c flat, b flat, and c: depress silently and catch sostenuto pedal with left foot; also, with left foot, engage soft pedal)

Piano

(use right hand: 4th finger) *pp* (use pedal to make legato)

Bass

pizz. *mf* *sosten. ped. to bar 4, beat 2* *arco* *sempre tenuto* *pp*

D.S.

pp *m.d.: 4th finger* *pp* *take wooden drum stricks* **Narrator:**
The fourth is mystery.

Pno.

pp *m.s.* *pp* *release sostenuto pedal*

Cb.

pp *m.d.: 4th finger* *mp* *mp* *p*

5

D.S.

p *H.H. closed* *crash* *mp* He jumps by himself

Pno.

Sometimes as my hand
Rests on the table

Cb.

bass harmonics sound at written octave
flautando *pp*

5.

$\text{♩} = 69$
take drum sticks

bars 3-5, improv. with bass, ending with cymbal on bar 5 down beat. etc.

Drum Set

Piano

Bass

lirico

mp

arco

5 5 5 etc.

f

f

free two bar improv. with drums

C7

5

$\text{♩} = 88-92$ comp the bass, slow swing, bars 8-27

ride

choke final 8th

D.S.

Pno.

Narrator(start on beat three):
Something stirs in the fifth
Of birth. Weak and submissive,
His touch is gentle.
It weighs a tear.
It takes the mote out of the eye.

mp

8va straight eighths

p

pizz.

mp

10

D.S.

Pno.

Cb.

mp

mp

3